Protocol of 1997. The UNFCCC was opened for signature on 9 May 1992. It came into force on 21 March 1994. As of December 2009, UNFCCC had 192 parties. The significance of the UNFCCC since it has come into force, can be found in the annual **Conferences of the Parties (COP)** to assess progress made in dealing with climate change. Since 1995 till the present, COP meets annually to discuss issues of climate change. The Kyoto Protocol is the result of such meetings.

Since 1995, sixteen such annual COPs have been held in Berlin (1995), Switzerland (1996), Kyoto (1997), Buenos Aires (1998 and 2004), Bonn (1999 and 2001), The Hague (2000), Marrakech (2001), New Delhi (2002), Milan (2003), Montreal (2005), Nairobi (2006), Bali (2007), Poznañ (2008), Copenhagen (2009) and Cancún (2010).

Some of the important Conferences and their outcomes are discussed below.

UN Climate Change Conference 2005 was held in Montreal. This was significant as this was the first **Meeting of the Parties** (MOP-1) to the Kyoto Protocol since their initial meeting in Kyoto in 1997. The **Montreal Action Plan** is an agreement reached out at the end of the conference to extend the life of the Kyoto Protocol beyond its 2012 expiration date and negotiate deeper cuts in greenhouse gas emissions.

UN Climate Change Conference 2007 was held at Bali, Indonesia where the notable event was the adoption of the **Bali Action Plan** for structured negotiation on the post-2012 framework (the end of the first commitment period of the Kyoto Protocol).

UN Climate Change Conference 2009 was held at Copenhagen, Denmark**.** It was the 15th Session of the Conference of the Parties to the UNFCCC and the fifth Meeting of the Parties (MOP). The goal of this meeting was to establish a successor to the Kyoto Protocol so that a global climate agreement could come into effect from 2013 after the expiry of the first commitment period under the Kyoto Protocol.

The **United Nations Climate Change Conference 2010** that took place in **Cancun**, Mexico, was the sixteenth Conference of the Parties (COP) and the sixth Meeting of the Parties (MOP) to the